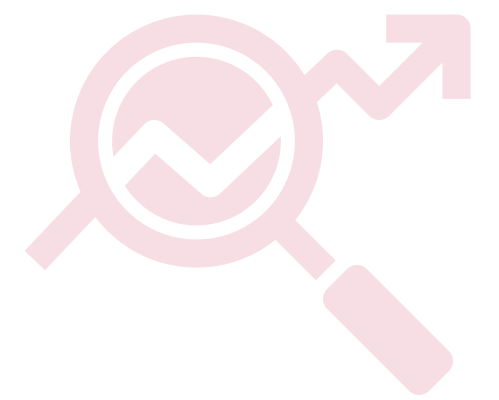


Self-Monitoring



What is it?

Self-monitoring is the process of tracking what you do: your thoughts, feelings, behaviours, and outcomes. This skill is particularly beneficial at the initial stages of the behaviour change process.



Research shows that self-monitoring can help increase and maintain physical exercise in the long-term, especially when using activity trackers/monitors.

How does it work?

There are two types of self-monitoring:

Behavioural Monitoring: recording frequency and duration of physical activity (e.g. how many days per week, how many minutes per week) and your experiences with physical activity (e.g. tracking emotions, effort levels).

In-Task Monitoring: recording things like **intensity, repetition, weight** during physical activity (e.g. number of sets and reps, heaviness of weights).

Overall, self-monitoring can help you track what you do, how long you do it for, or your effort level towards an activity. Depending on what **phase of change** you are in, you may track different things to progress towards your goals.

Phases of Change:

“Thinking” Phase

You are starting to think about doing physical activity. Self-monitoring can be used to understand where you currently spend your time.

“Action” Phase

You are actively working towards your physical activity goals. Self-monitoring can be used to track different aspects of your physical activity behaviour.

There are many tools that you can use to help you self-monitor:



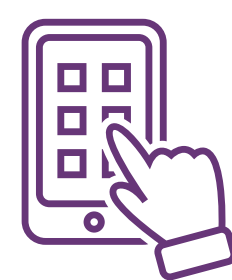
Journal



Watch



Log

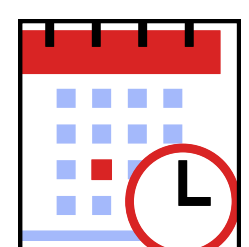


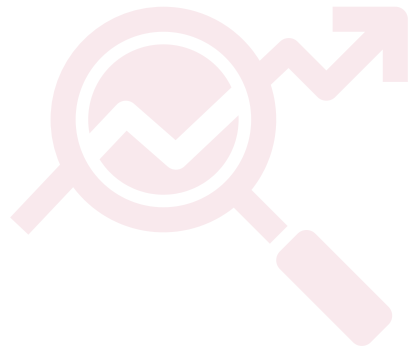
Apps

CASE STUDY

Emily deals with chronic pain that limits her mobility. She is trying to incorporate some aerobic physical activity into her life. Her goal is to do 30 minutes of aerobic activity 3 times per week. She uses self-monitoring to help her achieve this goal.

- **Thinking Phase:** Emily starts by logging her daily activities for a week to visualize her current routine. Using an agenda, she notes down what she does during the morning, afternoon, and evening of each day. After a week, she looks over her log and identifies some free time in her evenings where she could incorporate a 30-minute walk into her routine.
- **Action Phase:** Emily uses an app on her phone to log the days she goes on her walks. This helps Emily **stay on track** with her physical activity goal. She also wears a Fitbit that records how long she walks for and how far she goes. This helps Emily feel **motivated to continue** during her walks.





Your Turn

How do you use it?

1. What phase of change am I in?

- ☐ **“Thinking” Phase:** *Where can I fit time in for physical activity?*
- ☐ **“Action” Phase:** *Am I doing physical activity at the best times? Do I want to monitor aspects of my current physical activity?*

Why am I in this phase?

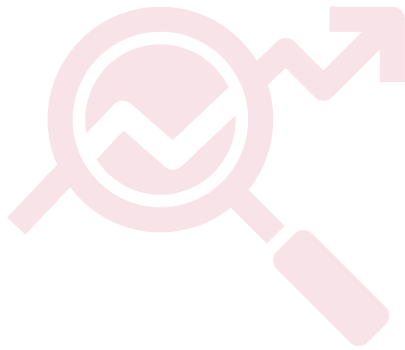
2. Choose what you want to track/monitor.

What do you want to track? Effort, time, intensity...

How will you track it? **Why this tool?** Journal, watch, app, log...

When will you track it? Morning, after a workout...

How often will you track it? Once per week, twice per day...

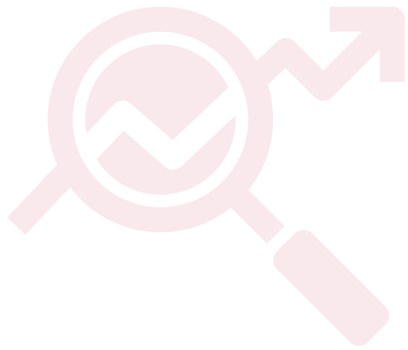


Your Turn

3. Example tools you can use for self-monitoring

Time Tracking Log to use during the “Thinking” Phase:

	Example	Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
5h00	sleep							
6h00								
7h00	breakfast							
8h00								
9h00	class							
10h00								
11h00								
12h00								
13h00	lunch							
14h00								
15h00	afternoon walk							
16h00								
17h00	yoga							
18h00	dinner							
19h00								
20h00	watch TV							
21h00								
22h00	sleep							
23h00								



Your Turn

Physical Activity Log to use during the “Action” Phase:

Day of the Week	Minutes of physical activity	Activity done	Feelings during activity	Other comments
Example: Monday	30 mins	Walking outside	happy, calm	It was hot outside so I walked slower than usual
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Saturday				
Sunday				



Reflection – *Self-Monitoring*

Reflect on your experience practicing and using self-monitoring this week. Use this space to write your overall impressions of using this skill. Respond to the reflection questions below:

- What have you enjoyed / not enjoyed about using self-monitoring?
- Do you need to change anything about your self-monitoring?
- How will you continue to use self-monitoring in the future?